1

Introduction

THE ORGANS of global governance, painstakingly constructed through decades of diplomatic negotiation and multilateral agreements, face unprecedented threats. Chief among them is the rise and spread of anti-globalization sentiment. An array of challenges has fueled opposition to global governance: rising economic inequality, mass migration, a global pandemic, the existential threat of climate change, technological disruptions, and the shifting international balance of power. People around the world feel forgotten, resentful, and disenchanted by the traditional political order—especially in working-class areas of many developed, deindustrializing, and decarbonizing democracies.

Those discontented with the globalized world increasingly coalesce around populist political ideologies. Charismatic populist leaders amplify these sentiments, promising a return to a bygone era. They lambaste the corrupt elite, blaming incumbent politicians and international actors alike for runaway globalization. These leaders argue that their countries should break loose from the shackles of economic interconnectedness and multilateralism that have sapped state sovereignty and diluted democracy. Across continents, populists advancing such messages have gathered political strength with fiery rhetoric that taps into longstanding fears and promises swift solutions to difficult problems.

As such leaders rise to power, their policies and ideas increasingly threaten established global networks and governing bodies. Populists preach nationalism, isolationism, and protectionism to their domestic audiences. In